

12 outreach scripts. Every relationship type.

Templates organized by relationship warmth and situation — not copy-paste, but frameworks you adapt into your own voice. The goal is always a conversation, not a job.

IF YOU TAKE NOTHING ELSE AWAY

Five things that matter most

- Ask for a conversation, not a job. Every message that asks for a job gets a wall. Every message that asks for 15 minutes gets a conversation.
- Be specific about what you're looking for. "I'm exploring senior finance roles in healthcare or fintech" is useful. "I'm open to a lot of things" is not.
- Short messages get more responses. Under 100 words is ideal. Under 150 is fine. Over 200 is almost never read.
- The warmer the relationship, the shorter the message. Close contacts need two sentences. Cold contacts need a clear hook.
- Always suggest one specific next step. "Would you have 15 minutes next week?" is easier to say yes to than "let me know if you'd like to connect."

The message that gets a meeting is short, specific, and asks for time — not a job. Every script here follows that structure.

Adapt these into your voice. The ones that sound like you will always outperform the ones that sound like a template.

WARM CONTACTS — PEOPLE WHO KNOW YOUR WORK

SCRIPT 1

Reconnecting with a former colleague

"[Name] — Hope you're well. I left [company] recently and I'm now looking for my next thing — targeting [specific role] in [industry/space]. I'd love to catch up and hear what you've been up to. Do you have 15 minutes sometime in the next two weeks?"

Use for: direct former colleagues who know your work. Keep it casual and personal. Don't ask for anything specific yet — the conversation comes first.

SCRIPT 2

Asking a warm contact for a specific introduction

"[Name] — Quick ask: I'm targeting [Company X] for a [role type] position and I noticed you're connected to [Person]. Would you be comfortable making an intro? Happy to send a brief note you could forward. Totally understand if it's not a great fit to make the ask."

Always give them an easy out. The ask is specific; the exit is easy. Send a short version of your background they can forward if they agree.

SCRIPT 3

Asking for a reference

"[Name] — I'm actively interviewing for [type of role] and expect some companies will ask for references soon. Would you be willing? If so, I'd love to have a quick call to align on what would be most helpful to emphasize."

Always brief your references before they're called. Tell them: your target role, two or three things you'd like them to highlight, and roughly when they might be contacted.

SCRIPT 4

Alumni outreach

"[Name] — I came across your profile through the [school] alumni network. I'm currently in transition and targeting [specific role] in [industry]. I noticed your background in [area] and I'd love to get your perspective on [specific question about their industry or path]. Would you be open to a 15-minute call?"

Alumni relationships are warmer than cold outreach but weaker than direct connections. The specific question makes you worth saying yes to. Generic "pick your brain" requests get ignored.

SCRIPT 5

Someone you met once at an event or conference

"[Name] — We met briefly at [event] in [year/month]. I'm now in transition and targeting [specific thing]. I've been following your work at [company] — [one specific genuine observation]. Would you be open to a short call sometime?"

Reference the specific meeting point. Show you know something real about their work. This converts at much higher rates than generic reconnection messages.

COLD OUTREACH — PEOPLE YOU DON'T KNOW

SCRIPT 6

Cold outreach to a hiring manager at a target company

"[Name] — I've been following [company]'s work in [area] for some time — [one specific genuine observation]. I'm a [function] leader with [X years] in [industry] currently looking for my next role. I'd be grateful for 15 minutes if you have it, even if there's nothing open on your team."

The key is the specific observation — it proves you're not mass-messaging. The "even if nothing's open" line lowers the stakes and gets more replies than messages that read as job applications.

SCRIPT 7

Cold outreach to a recruiter

"[Name] — I'm [function] professional with [X years] in [industry], currently looking for [specific role type]. My background: [one sentence]. I've worked at [notable company or two]. Would love to connect if my profile is relevant to any of your current searches."

Recruiters want to know: can I place this person? Be specific about function, level, and what you're looking for. If you're relevant, they'll respond quickly.

SCRIPT 8

Reaching out after a rejection

"[Name] — Thanks for letting me know. I appreciate the process and the time your team invested. If you're ever open to it, I'd genuinely welcome a few minutes to understand what tipped the decision — even a rough sense would help me calibrate. And if another relevant role comes up down the road, I hope you'll keep me in mind."

This converts better than it should. People are often willing to give honest feedback when the ask is humble and low-stakes. It also keeps the relationship alive for the next role.

SPECIALIZED SITUATIONS

SCRIPT 9

Reaching out to someone who can connect you to a hiring manager

"[Name] — I noticed you're connected to [person] at [company]. I'm targeting [company] for [role type] and I think it could be a strong fit. Would you be willing to make an intro — or even just let me use your name when I reach out? No pressure either way."

SCRIPT 10

Following up when you haven't heard back

"[Name] — Just a brief follow-up to my note from [X days] ago. I'm still very interested and wanted to make sure this didn't get lost. Happy to adjust if the timing isn't right."

One follow-up. Seven business days after the original. After that: move on.

SCRIPT 11

Informational request — when you want to learn about a company or role

"[Name] — I'm researching [company] as part of my search and your background in [area] would be really useful context. I have two or three specific questions about the team structure / culture / what you wish you'd known before joining. Would you have 15 minutes in the next couple of weeks?"

SCRIPT 12

Announcing your transition to your full network

"After [X years] at [company], I'm making a transition and looking for my next chapter. I'm focusing on [specific role] in [industry or two] — ideally [geography or remote]. If you know of anything or anyone who might be relevant, I'd be grateful. Open to introductions. Thank you."

Post this to LinkedIn after personal notes have gone out to your top 10–15 contacts. Keep it specific enough to be actionable. "Open to a lot of things" is not useful to your network.

NEXTCAPTER TOOL

Victoria generates personalized versions of these scripts in your voice, calibrated to your relationship with each contact and your comfort level with networking. Outreach Scripts are available from Week 2 onward at launchyournextchapter.com